MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 8/17/25 JM

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~U~~napproved minutes
July 16, 2025

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the agenda presented with the correction, **Motion carried.**

*Correction: Under Finance and Administration add a spot to close the hearing for the 2026 Budget

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Board of Commissioners' Minutes of June 18, 2025 and Closed Session Minutes of June 18, 2025, **Motion carried**.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Public Hearing for 2026 Budget
   Public hearing opened at 9:03 a.m.
   Public hearing closed at 9:15 a.m.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

A member of the public asked if the Commissioners' workload has decreased or increased since the number of Commissioners increased to nine and if all the Commissioners get paid the same amount. He received the response that all Commissioners are paid the same except for the Chairperson. He also asked if the Board has considered putting the check register online. He was told that is a question for Administrator Phelps or Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger.

A resident of Hayes Township was curious what the agenda item number one under the Communications List was. Administrator Lori Phelps explained that it is for the developers and property owners of the City of Harrison.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Resolutions Establishing Housing Exemption certificate District and Neighborhood Enterprise Zone, City of Harrison – No Discussion
2. Letter and Notice of DDA and LDFA meeting dates, City of Clare – No Discussion
3. Mid-State Health Network Resolution Opposing DHHS Plans to competitively procure Michigan's Pre-paid inpatient health plans – No Discussion
4. Resolution opposing proposed cuts to Medicaid, Ontonagon County – No Discussion
5. Washtenaw County Resolution opposing DHHS Plans to competitively procure Michigan's Pre-paid inpatient health plans – No Discussion
6. Medical Examiner's Report – No Discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Commissioners with updates from the State. The Michigan House and Senate are at a budget impasse. She has been focusing on completing the 2026 Fiscal Year Budget. She asked the Commissioners to keep an eye out for an incoming email from Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger regarding a class action lawsuit so they can respond and set up a special meeting at a later date. The budget is usually expended 79.19% but is only 67.16% expended so far this year.

JUSTICE

1. Homeland Security/Emergency Management
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Intergovernmental Agreement between West Michigan Regional Medical Consortium and Clare County for the 2026 Fiscal Year, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gross, Housler, Haskell, Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Hoefling and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

1. Board Vacancy, Department of Health and Human Services
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to appoint Chief Deputy Michael Bailey to serve on the Clare County DHHS Board for a three-year term expiring September 30, 2028, **Motion carried.**

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Region VII Area Agency on Aging
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to approve the proposed Annual Implementation Plan for Fiscal Year 2026, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Gross and Fancon
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - continued

2. Transit
It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Resolution #25-15 of Intent to Apply for Financial Assistance, correcting the financial figures previously adopted with Resolution #25-03, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Gilmore, Fancon, Housler, Hoefling, Kleinhardt and Gross
Nays: (0)
Absent: (0)
Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of June 23, 2025 in the amount of $226,148.47 and the meeting minutes of July 7, 2025 in the amount of $165,487.34, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Gross, Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Haskell and Housler
Nays: (0)
Absent: (0)
Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the expenditures for the month of June 2025 in the amount of $2,162,077.50 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,214,941.77, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Housler, Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Haskell, Gross, Ambrozaitis, Hoefling and Fancon
Nays: (0)
Absent: (0)
Motion carried.

3. Budget Fiscal Year 2026
It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to table the motion to approve Resolution #25-14, during discussion Commissioners sited areas of concern they would like to investigate prior to passing the budget, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (3) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Gross and Hoefling
Nays: (6) being Commissioners Fancon, Gilmore, Haskell, Housler, Majewski and Kleinhardt
Absent: (0)
Motion failed.

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Resolution #25-14 adopting the County General Appropriation Act for Fiscal Year 2026, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Haskell, Housler, Majewski, Fancon, Gilmore, Hoefling and Kleinhardt
Nays: (2) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis and Gross
Absent: (0)
Motion carried.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott informed the Board of Commissioners that the TextMyGov program that is in use in her office is quite effective. The public can ask questions via a text chat and Clerk/Register Mott can also push out notifications for elections, election inspector training, etc. Information is available on the Clerk's office website. The 55th Circuit Court clerks have noticed an increase in Personal Protections Orders (PPOs) along with an increase in the Family Court files. However, there has been a decrease in jury trials, there has only been one jury trial so far this year. The upcoming deadline for any ballot proposals for the November 2025 election is August 12, 2025 at 4:00 p.m.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. She explained that one of the reports is the penal fine monies paid out to libraries this time every year. The county's first public land sale auction this year will be online only on August 22, 2025.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore has been attending his meetings and there are no serious issues.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon gave a thanks to the Road Commission for their completed project on Colonville Road.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents. Frost Township expressed concerns about the lack of timeliness of the ambulance service.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis had nothing to report.

Commissioner Housler had nothing to report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt expressed concern over the Axe the Tax movement. If the proposal passes there is concern of how the local government services will be financed.

Commissioner Haskell had nothing to report.

Commissioner Gross announced that Farwell's Lumberjack Festival is July 18-19, 2025.

Commissioner Majewski had nothing to report.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps gave the State of the County Budget report during her Administrator's report.

PUBLIC COMMENT

A member of the public shared that he has seen Axe the Tax petitions, they are definitely out and about in the county.

Dewayne Rogers, Clare County Road Commission Manager, gave an update on upcoming and completed projects.

PUBLIC COMMENT - continued

A Clare County resident expressed concern over the staffing at the Prosecutor's office. They are overworked and need more staffing help.

Another citizen encouraged the Commissioners to educate their constituents on the Axe the Tax movement.

Hayes Township Supervisor, Brendon Powell stated that there was a fire at the Wagon Wheel Motel with 28 people displaced. He expressed gratitude towards Nate Hulliberger of the Clare County Road Commission for helping to direct traffic and donating money out of his pocket to feed those involved.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to adjourn the meeting at 10:08 a.m., **Motion carried**.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners